

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Pronunciation Spot: Let's talk about the Nile!



Learning Outcome

Describe detailed facts about events or actions in work and social contexts, in written or spoken situations.

Ask your partner:

- Would you like to live near a river?
- What would you do if there was a flood in your town? Would you be prepared? Why or why not?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about geography, climate and environmental problems.
- I can change emphasis by changing word order.
- I can stress words with suffixes.





Let's Explore!

People ask: **"Is the Nile the longest river in the world?"***

* The Amazon is not longer than the Nile. The Nile is longer but the Amazon carries a larger volume of water.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

The Nile, the longest river on the planet, has sustained life for eons. A narrow strip of land along the Nile's riverbanks and the delta at the mouth of the river has provided enough food to support a wealthy culture for thousands of years. In mid-June, Akhet -- or inundation -- began. In the past farmers let their land flood, leaving behind a layer of rich black mud. At this time farmers would mend tools or go fishing. Not until October did the growing season begin.

It wasn't until recently that the Nile river was not left to flood its bank. In the twentieth century, the Egyptian population grew so extensively, that flood control techniques were initiated with the construction of the Aswan Dam. The dam, which was completed in 1970, allows people to control the Nile waters in a system of reservoirs. These collect surplus water and release it slowly when and where it is needed for agriculture.

River control, however, has brought new problems. Farmers must use artificial fertilizers since they are no longer able to enjoy the river's gift of rich black mud, and the Nile delta is in serious danger of soil erosion and salinity. What is happening is that the soil is slowly being lost and what is left is becoming saltier. This not an ideal situation in the slightest! Moreover, the future of the Nile lies in question. As the population continues to increase and water becomes even more scarce, what will happen to the Nile? What will happen to those who inhabit its banks?



Let's Practice!

Jessie and Sam talk about the Nile.

Instructions: Complete each sentence by matching a half from 1 to 5 with a half from below. Read your sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

- | | |
|---|---|
| 1. The Nile, the longest river on the planet, | _____ a layer of rich black mud. |
| 2. A narrow strip of land along the Nile's riverbanks and the delta at the mouth of the river has provided enough food to | _____ has sustained life for eons. |
| 3. In the past farmers let their land flood, leaving behind | _____ mend tools or go fishing. |
| 4. At this time farmers would | _____ support a wealthy culture for thousands of years. |
| 5. Not until October | _____ did the growing season begin. |



Let's Practice!

Sam helps David with some stress-related issues!

Instructions: Use the Words from the Word Bank to correctly complete the sentences. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

Word Bank

artificial / initiated / construction / salinity / population / reservoirs / erosion

- Flood control techniques were _____ with the _____ of the Aswan Dam.
- The dam, which was completed in 1970, allows people to control the Nile waters in a system of _____.
- Farmers must use _____ fertilizers since they are no longer able to enjoy the river's gift of rich black mud.
- The Nile delta is in serious danger of soil _____ and _____.
- As the _____ continues to increase and water becomes even more scarce, what will happen to the Nile?





Extension Activity

Research a famous river.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Go online and research a river in any part of the world.
- Gather information on its size, the history of the population that lives near it and what life it sustains.
- Take notes on all the information.
- Without reading your notes word for word, give a presentation on the river.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I research a river.

☐ ☐

I write notes about the river.

☐ ☐

I present my information to a group.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **to sustain** (verb): to keep something in operation; to maintain
e.g. The Nile, the longest river on the planet, has sustained life for eons.
- **delta** (noun): low flat land where a river divides into small rivers
e.g. A narrow strip of land along the Nile riverbanks and the delta at the mouth of the river has provided enough food to support a wealthy culture.
- **inundation** (noun): an excessive amount of something
e.g. In mid-June the flooding known as Akhet ... or the inundation ... began.
- **extensively** (adverb): having considerable extent
e.g. The Egyptian population grew so extensively that flood control techniques were initiated with the construction of the Aswan Dam.
- **reservoir** (noun): natural or artificial lake which stores water
e.g. Reservoirs collect surplus water and release it slowly when and where it is needed for agriculture.
- **surplus** (noun): extra
e.g. Reservoirs collect surplus water and release it slowly when and where it is needed for agriculture.
- **artificial** (adjective): not natural; man-made
e.g. Farmers must use artificial fertilizers.
- **scarce** (adjective): rare
e.g. As the population continues to increase and water becomes even more scarce, what will happen to the Nile?





Learning Points

Changing Emphasis

You can change the order of a sentence to emphasize a particular word or phrase.

There are several different ways that emphasis can be changed:

Inversion involves changing the normal order of a sentence. You can put the prepositional phrase before the verb and the verb before the subject.

For example:

Normal structure: *The weasel jumped out of the box.*

Inversion: *Out of the box jumped the weasel.*

Fronting involves moving a clause from the end of a sentence to the front.

For example:

Normal structure: *I don't know who is going to pay for all of this.*

Fronting: *Who is going to pay for all of this, I don't know.*

Clefting or **Pseudo Clefting** involves beginning the sentence with "It is/was" or "What".

For example:

John spilled the coffee because he was in a rush.

It was John who spilled the coffee.

It was the coffee that John spilled.

It was because he was in a rush that John spilled the coffee.

I don't like when you talk back to me.

What I don't like is when you talk back to me.

Here are a few examples from the text:

Examples:

- *It wasn't until recently that the Nile river was not left to flood its banks.*
- *What is happening is that the soil is slowly being lost and what is left is becoming saltier.*





Learning Points

Identifying Stress in Words with Suffixes

You can look at the end of a word (the suffix) to determine where the stress is in that particular word.

The syllable that gets the accent depends on which suffix comes at the end of the word.

If the word ends with **-ic** or **-tion**, the stressed syllable (vowel) is one syllable from the end.

For example:

fanatic (fa-**na**-tic)
ecstatic (ecs-**ta**-tic)

introduction (in-tro-**duc**-tion)
conduction (con-**duc**-tion)

If the word ends with **-y** or **-ate**, the stressed syllable is **two** syllables from the end.

anomaly (a-**no**-ma-ly)
synergy (**sy**-ner-gy)

eliminate (e-**li**-mi-nate)
eviscerate (e-**vi**-scer-ate)

Look at these examples from the text:

Examples:

- *extensively*
- *population*
- *inundation*
- *erosion*
- *initiated*

